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1926, Dussehra Bomb Blast

Pandit Pearay Mohan's seminal work on the Punjab Rebellion of 1919[1] shows the year 1919 to be a pivotal one, not just because of the Amritsar Massacre, but the fact that it was preceded by the Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act of 1919. This is popularly known as the 'Rowlatt Act', and in being passed by the Imperial Legislative Council, the legislature of British India, it allowed political trials to be conducted in the absence of a jury and even the internment of suspects without trial. Gandhi set out to oppose this legislation by mobilizing a non-violent civil resistance (satyagraha) against its oppressive use. The act, passed in February, came into effect in March with many of Punjab's leaders being immediately arrested, and by April 1919 there was the Jallianwala Bagh shooting in Amritsar, when General Dyer took exception to an impromptu satyagraha meeting taking place there in the face of the ban on gatherings at the time that had come into effect under the Rowlatt Act. Bhagat Singh at the time was just twelve. He was studying at the DAV College. It is rumoured that incensed at the barbarity, Bhagat Singh tiptoed out of his house in Banga and travelled all the way to Amritsar the day after the massacre in order to collect the blood-soaked soil of the martyrs in a glass jar. The story is apocryphal and cannot have been true because Jallianwala Bagh was cordoned off by the police and barely accessible to a 12-year old, even if he could have got there from Banga on foot.[2] Common folklore in fact has it that, following his visit there, Bhagat Singh himself kept a bottle of the blood-soaked soil from the ground at Jallianwala Bagh.[3] That bottle is said to be housed in the Shaheed-e-Azam Sardar Bhagat Singh Museum in his ancestral village at *Khatkar Kalan* in Punjab, where it is said there lie,